

Palau International Ship Registry



Europe Head Office
Piraeus, 18536, Greece
5, Sachtouris Street
6th floor
T: +30 210 4293500
F: +30 210 4293505
info@palaureg.com

USA Head Office
The Woodlands, TX, 77380
9595 Six Pines Drive,
Suite 8210, Office 277
T: +1 832 631 6061
F: +1 832 631 6001
www.palaureg.com

MARINE CIRCULAR 106.1

To: ALL SHIPOWNERS, MANAGERS, MASTERS, CSO's, DEPUTY REGISTRARS AND RECOGNIZED ORGANIZATIONS

Subject: GUIDANCE FOR COMPANY SECURITY OFFICERS ON PREPARING A COMPANY AND CREW FOR THE CONTINGENCY OF A HIJACKING BY PIRATES IN HIGH RISK PIRACY AREAS

1. Reference

1.1. MSC/Circ. 1390, *Guidance for Company Security Officers (CSOs) – Preparation of a Company and Crew for the Contingency of Hijacking by Pirates in the Western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden*, dated December 9 2010

2. Purpose

2.1 This Marine Circular directed toward Company Security Officers (CSOs) to assist them in developing procedures to prepare crews for the contingency of their vessel being hijacked when transiting in High Risk Piracy Areas. It also addresses necessary actions of the Company in fulfilling its responsibility to the crew and highlights the need to prepare a crisis management plan that is designed specifically to handle hijacking and its effects on the crew.

3. Applicability

3.1 This Marine Circular applies to all CSO of the Republic of Palau flagged vessels that intend to transit through High Risk Piracy Areas.

4. Preparation of the Crew

4.1 Training Requirements: The CSO shall consider any contractual training or preparation requirements for the crew taking into consideration the nationality, flag and training of the crew.

4.2 Seafarers on Board the Vessel: Consider the rights of seafarers and what constitutes reasonable ground for disembarkation and repatriation prior to trading within High Risk Piracy Areas.

4.3 Other Personnel on Board the Vessel: Review the presence of other personnel onboard the vessel including partners, children, etc., and their safety during the transit on High Risk Piracy Areas.



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- 4.4 Crew Records: Ensure that the personal details of the crew members are up to date including contact details of the next of kin and existing medical conditions and medications.
- 4.5 Company Commitment: Ensure crews are aware of the Company's commitment to their health and safety.

5. Crew Awareness of the Hijack Environment

- 5.1 CSO should ensure that the crew is informed about the Hijack Environment including:
 - 5.1.1 Ensure that the crew are aware of the "shock of capture" and that the greatest anxiety is usually experienced in the hours after the initial hijack incident.
 - 5.1.2 Ensure that the crew understand the importance of being cooperative with the demands of the pirates.
 - 5.1.3 Ensure that the crew appreciate the importance of mutual support, teamwork and maintaining a shipboard routine both during and in the aftermath of the hijack incident.
 - 5.1.4 Ensure that the crew understand the importance of trying to maintain the standard of living conditions on board for the crew.
 - 5.1.5 The crew should understand that a demand to pose for photographs should not be resisted.
 - 5.1.6 Advise the crew to treat all information given to them by the pirates with caution.
 - 5.1.7 Ensure crew awareness of communication procedures to be followed during captivity by Company and crew in particular.
 - 5.1.8 Advise the crew of the need to be observant during captivity in their interest of recalling events clearly during the crew debrief post-incident.

6. Crew Awareness of Company Actions

- 6.1 Ensure that the crew are aware of Company crisis management procedures that will be undertaken during captivity and after release, in particular:
 - 6.1.1 Assurances that the Company will do everything practical to expedite release.
 - 6.1.2 Assurances of the Company's commitment to its continued obligations towards the crew in respect of safety, pay, employment, replacement of personal effects, etc.;
 - 6.1.3 Assurances that the Company will notify the next of kin in the event of an incident.
 - 6.1.4 Company policy on media relations during a hijack.



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6.2 Awareness of Company considerations/actions following release:

- 6.2.1 The provisions of supplies to the ship and crew as required post-incident, including food, water, fuel and clothing replacement.
- 6.2.2 The provisions of medical assistance, including counseling after the incident
- 6.2.3 The Company policy on post-incident press relations; and
- 6.2.4 The Company policy on post-incident debriefs and reviews of Crisis Management Procedures.

7. Company Crisis Management

7.1 The Company Crisis Management Procedures should include:

- 7.1.1 The Company's Board's designation of a head of crisis management answerable to the Board for the duration of the crisis and to lead the response effort;
- 7.1.2 Establishment of a single point of contact within the Company for contact with the pirates;
- 7.1.3 The composition of the management team and the roles and responsibilities involved during the hijacking;
- 7.1.4 The ongoing obligations to the crew in respect of such items as wages, employment, replacement of personal effects;
- 7.1.5 Communication policy during the crisis including communication between the company and ship, crew, crew's families and pirates;
- 7.1.6 Provisions of immediate medical assistance post-release including counseling;

8. Contact

- 8.1 Any inquiries concerning the subject for this Marine Circular should be directed to the Palau Ship Registry Administrator at technical@palaureg.

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